

Manas Owner's Guide

Every deterministic mechanism in the trading system, in plain language — what each piece computes, why it exists, what you may tweak, where, and what you should never touch.

For you, the operator. Nothing in this tool is a black box — every number below decomposes into rules you can read in the named file.

GOLDEN RULE FOR TWEAKING

Change **one number per quarter**, write it in `design/LEARNINGS.md`, and let the journal judge it. Rapid-fire tweaking = overfitting your own noise.

1. The Daily Pipeline

What runs every evening, in order. One command — `manas run-eod` — runs seven stages, each of which logs to `pipeline_runs`.

Stage	What it does	File
<code>ingest_bhavcopy</code>	NSE prices + delivery% into <code>daily_prices</code>	<code>sources/bhavcopy.py</code>
<code>universe_breadth</code>	NIFTYMIDSM400 breadth (up/down 4.5%, %>MAs)	<code>sources/universe_breadth.py</code>
<code>ingest_chartsmaze</code> (+scanners, disclosures)	Sector RS, 26 screeners, ASM, EPS growth, order-wins / deals	<code>sources/chartsmaze*.py</code> , <code>sources/disclosures.py</code>
<code>indicators</code>	Per-stock EMAs / ATR / ADR / RSI / stage etc. → <code>features_daily</code>	<code>engine/indicators.py</code>
<code>ingest_mars</code>	Sector-vs-benchmark strength	<code>regime/mars_ingest.py</code>
<code>regime_snapshot</code>	XP + MBI + <code>market_mode</code>	<code>regime/snapshot.py</code>
<code>scan_candidates</code>	The refusal cascade + ranked feed + refusal ledger	<code>scanner/candidates.py</code>

2. The Regime — "How Aggressive Today"

Implemented in `regime/`.

XP dial — `xp.py`

Recursive breadth-energy formula on the 400-stock midsmall universe. Bands:

- < 15 low · 15–40 building · 40–100 strong · > 100 extreme

NEVER Don't tweak the formula — it's calibrated to the reference. Seeds live in config (`regime.xp_seed`).

MBI ratios — `snapshot.py`

- 20R ≥ 75 green / < 50 red
- 50R ≥ 85 green / < 60 red
- 4.5R burst < 50 red · 200–400 green · ≥ 400 orange

Day color = net of column colors; warning day = 3+ red columns. **NEVER** Thresholds are the reference methodology — don't tweak.

market_mode

RISK_ON / SELECTIVE / DEFENSIVE / NO_TRADE — derived from pillars + breadth + warnings.

The Governor — `governor.py` — regime becomes law

Mode	Max cards shown	Allowed setup families	Pushes
RISK_ON	8	all	on
SELECTIVE	4	catalyst, base/pattern	on
DEFENSIVE	2	catalyst only	off
NO_TRADE	0	none	off

TWEAK Tweak in `regime/governor.py` (`MAX_CARDS`, `ALLOWED_FAMILIES`). Widening these is the single easiest way to destroy the tool's edge — the refusal IS the product.

3. The Cascade — "Which Stocks Even Qualify"

Implemented in `scanner/gates.py`. Every candidate must pass **all six gates, in order**. Each failure produces a named reason in the refusal ledger (`/api/setups/refusals`). Current live behavior: ~600 pool → ~23 pass.

Gate 1 — Regime

Is this setup family allowed today (per the governor table above)?

Gate 2 — Tradability

- Not an ETF (keyword list in `engine/universe_filter.py` — **TWEAK** add symbols when you spot a leaked fund)
- Price $\geq$ ₹30, avg turnover $\geq$ ₹5cr
- Not circuit-locked, **not ASM-flagged**
- Not a lottery profile (single-day gain $\geq$ 18% on a $\leq$ ₹3000cr name)
- Not a pump signature (delivery 3σ spike + micro-cap + no disclosure)

TWEAK Floors: `GateConfig` in `universe_filter.py` (`min_price`, `min_avg_turnover_cr`, `min_market_cap_cr`). MAX/pump thresholds in `gates.py` — leave unless the journal proves otherwise.

Gate 3 — Trend template (J Law)

- Close > 50SMA > 200SMA
- EMA stack 9 > 21 > 50 ("Lead")
- Within 15% of 52-week high (nearness $\geq$ 0.85)

- $RS \geq 80$

Catalyst setups (EP / IPO) are exempt from history / nearness. **TWEAK** `RS_FLOOR` , `NEARNESS_ENTRY` in `gates.py` — 0.85 / 80 are research-anchored; loosen only with journal evidence.

Gate 4 — Fresh leg (anti-chase)

Refuses extended names: $> 8\%$ above 21EMA, or $> 8\%$ above pivot, or leg older than 15 bars, or parabolic-at-high on fading volume. This is your anti-chase protection. **NEVER** `EXT21_STALE` , `PIVOT_STALE` — don't raise these; chasing is the #1 killer.

Gate 5 — Participation

$\text{Delivery}_z \geq 0$ (delivery vs the stock's *own* 50-day norm — a 60%-always name at 60% is noise; a 30%-name at 55% is accumulation). Breakout-day entries also need volume $\geq 1.2\times$ average and range expansion ($TR \geq 1.2\times \text{ATR}_{14}$, else "narrow-range" caution).

Gate 6 — Risk

See §4. If the math doesn't clear, the trade is refused, not displayed.

RANK — NO MORE 0-100 SCORE

Survivors are ordered 1..M by (delivery_z, sector-adjusted momentum, confluence families). "Rank 2 of 4 today." Grades: **A+** = top-3 AND ≥ 2 boosts · **A** = any boost · **B** = passed. A name showing real weakness (distribution / lower-low) is capped B.

4. Risk Math — Stop / Size / R:R

`risk/plan.py` is the **only** writer of these numbers.

Stop

The tightest of three *real* levels: trigger-bar low · entry – $1.2\times \text{ATR}_{20}$ · 10-bar base low (with buffer). **Never** an arbitrary %.

Caps (initial stop distance)

Regime	Cap
RISK_ON	$\leq 6\%$
SELECTIVE	$\leq 5\%$
DEFENSIVE	$\leq 4\%$
EP / IPO exception	$\leq 7.5\%$
$> 8\%$	always refused
$< 1\%$	refused (noise)

R:R floor

1.5 (currently soft — measured-move is derived; structural targets coming).

Size

Size = capital × risk% ÷ stop-distance, qty floored.

YOUR PROFILE — CONFIG.YAML UNDER RISK:

- `profile`: `aggressive` (default — small account, grow fast) or `standard`
- `capital`: `1000000` ← **SET THIS to your real capital**
- Aggressive bands: 0.75% / 0.50% / 0.30% risk per trade by regime (hard max 1.0% / 0.75% / 0.40%), open-risk ceiling 3.0% / 2.0% / 1.0%, max 5 open positions, max 2/day new
- The aggression is in **size only** — stops and gates are identical in both profiles

Sector rule

Max 2 open per sector; a 3rd correlated name sizes at half.

Progressive exposure

NEVER If your last-10 closed trades average negative R, size halves automatically until you're back above water. Not tweakable — this is the drawdown brake.

5. Setup Detectors

What patterns it sees. Implemented in `engine/eod_detectors.py` and `price_action.py`. All pure OHLCV rules; each fires with a plain-English detail string.

EP (episodic pivot)

≥ 30% QoQ and YoY growth in EPS + sales, quiet pre-gap base (25-bar band ≤ 25%, drift ≤ 10%), gap-up, mkt-cap > ₹300cr, skip if gap + range > 12%. **TWEAK** the 30% growth bar is the StockBee reference — leave it.

IPO base

First inside-bar / mini-coil or range-squeeze after listing, hard ≤ 4% stop.

Launch Pad

Price within 3% of 21/50SMA + 65EMA cluster, stacked & rising, volume confirm.

Classic triggers

Pocket pivot · shakeout · EMA touch-reclaim · VCP · ANTS accumulation — classic momentum / accumulation triggers, all thresholded in code with comments.

Exit engine (Market Navigator)

Named weakness rules → **Intact** / **Weakening** / **Broken**. Broken (50/200SMA lost) = exit voice; two-strike composite (any 2 in 5 sessions) = exit now.

Trail plan

- 0 → +1R hold structure stop
- at +1R move to breakeven + book $\frac{1}{3}$
- trend-trail 10EMA (catalyst) or 21EMA
- extension (> 8% over 21EMA) book another tranche

TWEAK the booking fractions ($\frac{1}{3}$, 25–33%) are Luk-style defaults; the journal will tell you if your winners need more room.

6. The Journal Loop — Your Private Edge

FEED IT!

This dataset is the one thing no free site can copy — after ~6 months it starts telling you which setups pay *you*, in which regimes.

- Every card gets **TAKEN** / **SKIPPED** (+reason) — skipping is a decision; log it. The tool snapshots the full context automatically.
- Nightly, every candidate (taken or not) gets T+5 / 10 / 20 forward returns, MFE / MAE.
- Expectancy per (setup × regime) cell with shrinkage toward the parent mean — a cell's numbers are only trusted at:
 - $n \geq 20$ descriptive
 - $n \geq 75$ ranking
 - $n \geq 150$ operational

Your personal cells need $n \geq 30$ before they override the system's.

- **Probation:** IPO-base / flag / high-ADR setups trade at HALF size with an "unproven — building sample" chip until their cell earns ≥ 40 observations with positive expectancy. Evidence-strong setups (EP, pullback) start at full size.

TWEAK Your job: log every decision honestly (especially skips and mistake tags).

7. What You Tweak vs What You Don't

Policy	What's in scope
TWEAK FREELY	<code>risk.capital</code> , <code>risk.profile</code> , ETF keyword additions, watchlist, mentors.
QUARTERLY	One at a time, logged in <code>LEARNINGS.md</code> : gate floors (RS, nearness, turnover), governor card caps, trail booking fractions.
NEVER TWEAK	XP / MBI formulas (reference-calibrated), the > 8% stop refusal, the progressive-exposure brake, ASM exclusion, the one-opinion rule, additive scoring (gone — don't reintroduce), anything the journal hasn't earned with $n \geq$ the trust ladder.

Where numbers live

Number type	Location
LOCKED table	the plan file
Gates	<code>scanner/gates.py</code>
Risk	<code>risk/plan.py</code> + <code>config.yaml</code>
Governor	<code>regime/governor.py</code>
Detectors	<code>engine/eod_detectors.py</code>
Every change log	<code>design/LEARNINGS.md</code>